STATE SCAN

WEST BENGAL: MURMURS IN MURSHIDABAD **PG 19**

J&K: THE VALLEY OF WOES **PG 22**



'OUR SATLUJ' CM Bhagwant Mann visits Nangal dam, May 1

PRABHJOT GILL

▶ PUNJAB-HARYANA

WAR OVER WATER SHARING HOTS UP

Possessive about river water, Punjab takes the unprecedented step of seizing control of Bhakra Nangal flow. Haryana seethes with anger and thirst

By **Anilesh S. Mahajan**

TWO SIBLING RIVALS SPLIT by a border, profound rage over ownership of water, a war-like air...you'd think this was India-Pakistan. But no, take away the artillery, and the words fit Punjab-Haryana well. Consider the unusual sight that greeted engineers and staff at Bhakra Nangal on May 3 morning. A regiment of Punjab Police—two DSPs, two dozen uniformed cops—had alighted to seize the dam's controls!

What gives? Well, on April 30—curiously, at midnight—the Bhakra Beas Management Board (BBMB) had cleared an extra 8,500 cusecs of water to Haryana: for drinking. Punjab saw a damburst of anger. It had met its obligations—and more, it argued. Punjab's BBMB member, Rajesh Mahajan, quit in protest, calling the fiat "arbitrary"